

MODULE

3

Meet in the Middle

"You must speak words that matter."

— KATE DICAMILLO

ESSENTIAL QUESTION

How can people work out disagreements?

MAIN STORIES

1 **Big Red Lollipop** · Rukhsana Khan REALISTIC FICTION

2 **Working with Others** · Robin Nelson INFORMATIONAL

3 **Gingerbread for Liberty!** · Mara Rockliff BIOGRAPHY

4 **Pepita and the Bully** · Ofelia Dumas Lachtman REALISTIC FICTION

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B · Reading Comprehension (32)	p. 7
C · IB Critical Thinking (5)	p. 15
D · MAP Practice (20)	p. 18

NAME _____ DATE _____



Worksheet A — Vocabulary

Module 3 · Meet in the Middle · Grade 2 · 27 Items

CCSS L.2.4 · L.2.5 · L.2.6

NAME _____ DATE _____

Directions. Read each question carefully. Watch out for tricky choices. Fill in the circle next to the BEST answer.

BIG IDEA WORDS

Q1 L.2.6

compromise

A **compromise** is when people —

- ☐ A. shout louder than the other person
- ☐ B. agree on every single thing
- ☐ C. walk away with nothing to say
- ☐ D. each give up a little of what they want

Q2 L.2.6

decision

When you make a **decision**, you —

- ☐ A. make up your mind about something
- ☐ B. ask everyone else to choose for you
- ☐ C. change your mind again and again
- ☐ D. wait and pick nothing at all

Q3 L.2.6 TRAP

disagreement

In a **disagreement**, people —

- ☐ A. share the very same idea
- ☐ B. get along with no trouble at all
- ☐ C. have different ideas about things
- ☐ D. agree on every plan right away

Q4 L.2.4

invited

"Ami! I've been **invited** to a birthday party!" When you are **invited**, you are —

- ☐ A. told you may not come
- ☐ B. sent away from a place
- ☐ C. left out and forgotten
- ☐ D. asked to come to something

Q5 L.2.4

screams

"Sana **screams**, 'I wanna go too!'" To **scream** is to —

- ☐ A. cry out in a loud, sharp voice
- ☐ B. whisper softly to a friend
- ☐ C. hum a quiet little tune
- ☐ D. speak in a calm, low voice

Q6 L.2.4

plead

"I beg and **plead**, but Ami won't listen." To **plead** means to —

- ☐ A. ask in an angry, mean way
- ☐ B. stay quiet and say nothing
- ☐ C. ask hard, like begging, for something
- ☐ D. tell someone firmly what to do

Q7 L.2.5 TRAP

musical

A **musical** ring or toy is —

- ☐ A. a stage show with singing and acting
- ☐ B. something that makes no sound at all
- ☐ C. something that makes music or sound
- ☐ D. a person who plays an instrument well

Q8 L.2.4

shove

"I **shove** aside the coats and boots." To **shove** means to —

- ☐ A. pull someone toward you
- ☐ B. push hard with the body
- ☐ C. tap someone gently on the arm
- ☐ D. wait your turn without moving

Q9 L.2.4

scoots

When someone **scoots**, they —

- ☐ A. move quickly in short, small slides
- ☐ B. sit down and stay in one place
- ☐ C. walk in slow, heavy steps
- ☐ D. jump straight up in the air

Q10 L.2.5 TRAP

greedy

A **greedy** child is one who —

- ☐ A. shares everything quickly
- ☐ B. gives away the biggest piece
- ☐ C. wants more than is fair, just for themselves
- ☐ D. loves the color green most

Q11 L.2.4

scurries

"Sana **scurries** after it and eats that too." To **scurry** is to —

- ☐ A. walk slowly with heavy steps
- ☐ B. stand still in one spot
- ☐ C. stroll along without any rush
- ☐ D. hurry along with small, quick steps

Q12 L.2.4 TRAP

blamed

"You are **blamed** for something you didn't do." When you are **blamed**, people —

- ☐ A. say something is your fault
- ☐ B. thank you for your good help
- ☐ C. make a flame with a match
- ☐ D. forgive you and let it go

Q13 L.2.4

argue

"Maybe you **argue** with a friend." To **argue** means to —

- ☐ A. agree on every word right away
- ☐ B. talk in an angry way because you do not agree
- ☐ C. talk calmly and reach an agreement
- ☐ D. stay silent and say nothing back

Q14 L.2.6

respectful

A **respectful** person —

- ☐ A. shouts over other people
- ☐ B. laughs at others' mistakes
- ☐ C. treats other people in a kind, polite way
- ☐ D. is rude and ignores how others feel

Q15 L.2.5 TRAP

practice

In the text, you can **practice** ways to solve a problem. Here, **practice** means —

- ☐ A. a place where a doctor sees people
- ☐ B. do something over and over to get better
- ☐ C. a usual way a group always does things
- ☐ D. do something right the very first time

Q16 L.2.4

booming

"His **booming** laugh." A **booming** sound is —

- ☐ A. very soft and tiny
- ☐ B. loud and deep
- ☐ C. high and squeaky
- ☐ D. said only in a whisper

Q17 L.2.5

TRAP

skill

The baker had a **skill** for making the best gingerbread. Here, **skill** means —

- ☐ A. the flat ledge at the foot of a window
- ☐ B. a part of a head bone
- ☐ C. the ability to do something well
- ☐ D. a lucky guess that cannot be learned

Q18 L.2.4

threatening

A **threatening** letter or voice is one that —

- ☐ A. sounds soft and friendly
- ☐ B. says it will hurt or harm
- ☐ C. promises to keep you safe
- ☐ D. says, "Please come in and rest."

Q19 L.2.4

persuade

"Perhaps I can **persuade** them to switch sides." To **persuade** someone is to —

- ☐ A. force them with no choice given
- ☐ B. agree with whatever they already think
- ☐ C. confuse them so they cannot decide
- ☐ D. use words to change their mind

Q20 L.2.4

wrinkledA **wrinkled** face or paper is —

- ☐ A. covered with small folds or lines
- ☐ B. smooth and flat all over
- ☐ C. soft and brand new
- ☐ D. pressed without a single crease

Q21 L.2.4

frownWhen you **frown**, your face shows that you are —

- ☐ A. happy and excited
- ☐ B. smiling with joy
- ☐ C. calm and content
- ☐ D. not happy or pleased

Q22 L.2.4

yankedWhen Babette **yanked** on something, she —

- ☐ A. pulled it with one quick, sharp tug
- ☐ B. tugged it slowly and gently
- ☐ C. pushed it softly away
- ☐ D. let go of it right away

Q23 L.2.4

draggedIf someone **dragged** a bag, they —

- ☐ A. lifted it up and carried it high
- ☐ B. pulled it slowly along the ground
- ☐ C. pushed it quickly ahead of them
- ☐ D. set it down and left it there

Q24 L.2.4

mumbled

When Pepita **mumbled**, she spoke —

- ☐ **A.** loud and clear like a teacher
- ☐ **B.** in crisp words easy to understand
- ☐ **C.** with a yell across the room
- ☐ **D.** low and not very clearly

Q25 L.2.4

nearby

Something **nearby** is —

- ☐ **A.** close, not far away
- ☐ **B.** far off in another country
- ☐ **C.** a long way down the road
- ☐ **D.** too distant to walk to

Q26 L.2.5

TRAP

excuses

"Stop making **excuses!**" Pepita said." Here, **excuses** are —

- ☐ **A.** polite words that mean "sorry, may I pass?"
- ☐ **B.** reasons given to not do something
- ☐ **C.** notes that let a student miss school
- ☐ **D.** honest promises to try your best

Q27 L.2.4

hesitant

A **hesitant** person is —

- ☐ **A.** bold and ready to jump right in
- ☐ **B.** sure and quick to act
- ☐ **C.** slow to act because they are unsure
- ☐ **D.** certain and full of confidence



Worksheet B — Reading Comprehension

Module 3 · Meet in the Middle · Grade 2

CCSS RL.2.1 – RL.2.7 / RI.2.1 – RI.2.8

NAME _____ DATE _____

Directions. Use what you remember from each story to answer the questions. Fill in the circle next to the best answer.

Story 1 · Big Red Lollipop

REALISTIC FICTION · RUKHSANA KHAN · 8 QUESTIONS

Q1 RL.2.1

Who is the narrator who tells the story?

- ☐ **A.** Sally, the friend at the party.
- ☐ **B.** Sana, the middle sister.
- ☐ **C.** Rubina, the oldest sister.
- ☐ **D.** Maryam, the youngest sister.

Q2 RL.2.3

Why does Ami say Rubina must bring Sana to the party?

- ☐ **A.** Sana already knows the birthday girl.
- ☐ **B.** Sally asked for two guests.
- ☐ **C.** The party is at Sana's school.
- ☐ **D.** Ami says it would not be fair to leave her sister at home.

Q3 RL.2.3

What does Sana do to Rubina's big red lollipop?

- ☐ **A.** She gives it back the next day.
- ☐ **B.** She trades it for a ring.
- ☐ **C.** She hides it in her room.
- ☐ **D.** She eats most of it so only a triangle on a stick is left.

Q4 RL.2.3

When Ami says, "It's just a lollipop! Can't you share with your little sister?" how does Rubina feel?

- ☐ **A.** Quiet and pleased.
- ☐ **B.** Calm and proud.
- ☐ **C.** Sleepy and bored.
- ☐ **D.** Angry and unfairly treated.

Q5 RL.2.3

Later in the story, Sana is invited to her OWN party. What does she want to do?

- ☐ **A.** Go without taking any sister at all.
- ☐ **B.** Stay home and not go.
- ☐ **C.** Bring Ami to the party.
- ☐ **D.** Take Maryam, the youngest sister, with her.

Q6 RL.2.3

What does Rubina ask Ami to do for Sana?

- ☐ **A.** Make Sana take Maryam, like before.
- ☐ **B.** Punish Sana for the lollipop.
- ☐ **C.** NOT make Sana take Maryam to the party.
- ☐ **D.** Cancel the party.

Q7 RL.2.2 TRAP

What LESSON does "Big Red Lollipop" teach?

- ☐ **A.** Big sisters should never have to share a party with little sisters.
- ☐ **B.** A mother's rule is always right, even when it feels unfair.
- ☐ **C.** Eating someone else's lollipop is the worst thing a sister can do.
- ☐ **D.** Choosing kindness, even when it is hard, can stop a chain of hurt feelings.

Q8 RL.2.6

From WHOSE point of view is "Big Red Lollipop" told?

- ☐ **A.** From Ami's (the mother's) point of view.
- ☐ **B.** From Sana's point of view, the younger sister.
- ☐ **C.** From Rubina's point of view — she tells the story in the first person, using "I."
- ☐ **D.** From the friend Sally's point of view.

Story 2 · Working with Others

INFORMATIONAL · ROBIN NELSON · 8 QUESTIONS

Q9 RI.2.2

What is "Working with Others" MAINLY about?

- ☐ **A.** One boy and the day he lost his lunch box.
- ☐ **B.** How to solve problems and get along with other people.
- ☐ **C.** The steps you follow to bake gingerbread cookies.
- ☐ **D.** Writing a poem about a river and the water in it.

Q10 RI.2.1 TRAP

According to the text, when do people sometimes have conflicts?

- ☐ **A.** Only when someone calls them a mean name.
- ☐ **B.** Only when they argue with a friend at school.
- ☐ **C.** When they work and play with others every day.
- ☐ **D.** Only when someone takes one of their toys.

Q11 RI.2.8

The author says that yelling, screaming, and hitting do NOT solve conflicts. What reason does the author give to support this?

- ☐ **A.** They make angry feelings go away for good.
- ☐ **B.** They hurt people and make problems worse.
- ☐ **C.** They help everyone calm down right away.
- ☐ **D.** They are the fastest way to win a fight.

Q12 RI.2.1 TRAP

Which is ONE example the text gives of a conflict?

- ☐ **A.** Someone takes one of your toys.
- ☐ **B.** You take deep breaths and count slowly to calm down.
- ☐ **C.** You ask an adult to help you solve a problem.
- ☐ **D.** Two people compromise and each give up a little.

Q13 RI.2.3

According to the text, what is ONE good way to solve a problem?

- ☐ **A.** Yell so loudly the other person stops talking.
- ☐ **B.** Walk away and never say anything.
- ☐ **C.** Blame the other person right away.
- ☐ **D.** Be respectful and listen to the other person.

Q14 RI.2.5

"Working with Others" is organized to —

- ☐ **A.** tell a long, made-up adventure story.
- ☐ **B.** show a play with stage directions.
- ☐ **C.** rhyme like a poem from start to end.
- ☐ **D.** explain ideas about conflict and give ways to solve it.

Q15 RI.2.6

Why MOST LIKELY did the author write "Working with Others"?

- ☐ **A.** To make readers laugh out loud with a silly story.
- ☐ **B.** To get readers to buy a brand-new kind of toy.
- ☐ **C.** To teach readers how to handle conflicts in kind ways.
- ☐ **D.** To tell readers a long, made-up bedtime story.

Q16 RI.2.3 TRAP

According to "Working with Others," which TWO steps work TOGETHER to help solve a conflict?

- ☐ **A.** Use respectful words AND listen carefully to the other person.
- ☐ **B.** Apologize when you are wrong AND then walk away without listening.
- ☐ **C.** Take deep breaths to calm down AND then blame the other person.
- ☐ **D.** Ask an adult for help AND make sure only one side gets to speak.

Story 3 · Gingerbread for Liberty!

BIOGRAPHY · MARA ROCKLIFF · 8 QUESTIONS

Q17 RI.2.1

Where does most of "Gingerbread for Liberty!" take place?

- ☐ **A.** Philadelphia and the American colonies during the Revolutionary War.
- ☐ **B.** A small island in the ocean.
- ☐ **C.** A prairie dog burrow.
- ☐ **D.** A modern-day playground.

Q18 RI.2.3

Who is the main person the text is about?

- ☐ **A.** A young soldier from the king.
- ☐ **B.** The gingerbread baker who lived in Philadelphia.
- ☐ **C.** General George Washington's son.
- ☐ **D.** The king of England.

Q19 RI.2.3

Why does the baker leave home?

- ☐ **A.** To fight for his America, as a soldier.
- ☐ **B.** To visit a cousin in England.
- ☐ **C.** To sell gingerbread at the beach.
- ☐ **D.** To learn to dance and sing.

Q20 RI.2.3

What does the baker do when he meets General Washington?

- ☐ **A.** He turns around and walks home.
- ☐ **B.** He rolls up his sleeves and offers to feed the soldiers — "No empty bellies here!"
- ☐ **C.** He asks for a horse and rides off.
- ☐ **D.** He runs back to the king of England.

Q21 RI.2.3

The baker asks Washington to let him go speak to the foreign soldiers. WHY?

- ☐ **A.** Because they came from the land where he was born — he can persuade them.
- ☐ **B.** Because he wants to sell them bread for money.
- ☐ **C.** Because the king of England asked him to.
- ☐ **D.** Because he is hiding from the army.

Q22 RI.2.3

What happens to the foreign soldiers after the baker speaks to them?

- ☐ **A.** They march straight to the king.
- ☐ **B.** They switch sides instead of fighting.
- ☐ **C.** They throw the gingerbread away.
- ☐ **D.** They sail home that same night.

Q23 RI.2.6 TRAP

Why MOST LIKELY did the author write "Gingerbread for Liberty!"?

- ☐ **A.** To show a real hero who helped America with kindness, not weapons.
- ☐ **B.** To explain how to bake gingerbread for a school fair.
- ☐ **C.** To teach readers General Washington's battle plans.
- ☐ **D.** To describe how the king of England trained his soldiers.

Q24 RI.2.8

What does the text show about how problems can be solved?

- ☐ **A.** Big problems can only ever be solved with soldiers and weapons.
- ☐ **B.** The best thing soldiers can do is always march away from a fight.
- ☐ **C.** Kind words and a shared meal can end a fight that an army could not.
- ☐ **D.** Only a king has the power to stop a war between two sides.

Story 4 · Pepita and the Bully

REALISTIC FICTION · OFELIA DUMAS LACHTMAN · 8 QUESTIONS

Q25 RL.2.1

Who is the bully in the story?

- ☐ **A.** Mindy, who plays hopscotch.
- ☐ **B.** Babette, a classmate at school.
- ☐ **C.** Mrs. Green, the neighbor.
- ☐ **D.** Juan, Pepita's brother.

Q26 RL.2.3

What mean thing does Babette say to Pepita?

- ☐ **A.** She tells Pepita her shoes are pretty.
- ☐ **B.** She invites Pepita to play.
- ☐ **C.** "Pepita, yuck. That's not a name."
- ☐ **D.** "I will tell the teacher right now."

Q27 RL.2.3

What advice does Pepita's brother Juan give?

- ☐ **A.** "Hit her back twice as hard."
- ☐ **B.** "Tell Mama you cannot go to school."
- ☐ **C.** "Just don't fight with her. Bullies like fights."
- ☐ **D.** "Run home as fast as you can."

Q28 RL.2.3

Who does Pepita visit and ask if her name is bad?

- ☐ **A.** Mrs. Green, the neighbor digging in her garden.
- ☐ **B.** Miss Chu, her teacher.
- ☐ **C.** Mindy, her classmate.
- ☐ **D.** Sally, a friend from a party.

Q29 RL.2.3

In the end, what does Pepita ask Babette?

- ☐ **A.** "Why don't you ever come to school?"
- ☐ **B.** "What do you like?"
- ☐ **C.** "Where did you get those shoes?"
- ☐ **D.** "Will you tell my mom?"

Q30 RL.2.3

How does Pepita change between the start and the end of the story?

- ☐ **A.** She stays just as hesitant and silent as she was at the start.
- ☐ **B.** She turns mean and becomes a bully herself by the end.
- ☐ **C.** She grows from being upset and hesitant to standing up with kind, honest words.
- ☐ **D.** She gives up on the problem and moves to a brand-new school.

Q31 RL.2.2

What is the LESSON of "Pepita and the Bully"?

- ☐ **A.** A bully will never change, so there is no use in trying.
- ☐ **B.** Standing up with kindness and honest words can change a bully better than fighting back.
- ☐ **C.** Only a grown-up like a teacher can ever solve this kind of problem.
- ☐ **D.** The safest plan is to stay home and avoid the bully for good.

Q32 RL.2.6

Whose point of view does the story show?

- ☐ **A.** The teacher Miss Chu's view of the class.
- ☐ **B.** Babette's view of her family.
- ☐ **C.** Mama's view of the neighborhood.
- ☐ **D.** Pepita's view — what SHE feels, sees, and decides.



Worksheet C — IB Critical Thinking

Module 3 · Meet in the Middle · Grade 2

IB PYP Key Concepts · DOK 2 – 4

NAME _____ DATE _____

Directions. Use what you learned from each story to think more deeply. Each question helps you grow as an IB learner.

Q1

Perspective

DOK 2

In "**Big Red Lollipop**," Rubina and Sana feel very different things about the party. Show each sister's point of view.

TWO SISTERS · TWO POINTS OF VIEW

RUBINA — OLDER SISTER

SANA — YOUNGER SISTER

Why is it important to see BOTH points of view in a disagreement?

Q2

Responsibility

DOK 3

In "**Working with Others,**" what are FOUR ways a person can take responsibility in a conflict? Fill in the web with ideas from the text.

WAYS TO TAKE RESPONSIBILITY

Working It Out

WAY 1

WAY 2

WAY 3

WAY 4

Which one is HARDEST for you? Why?

Q3

Causation

DOK 3

In "**Gingerbread for Liberty!**," the baker's KIND ACTIONS change what happens. Show the cause and effect.

CAUSE & EFFECT

CAUSE · WHAT THE BAKER DOES



EFFECT · WHAT THE SOLDIERS DO

What does this show about how problems can be solved?

Q4

Connection

DOK 3

In "**Pepita and the Bully**," Pepita slowly changes. Track her steps from feeling hesitant to standing up with kindness.

PEPITA'S THREE STEPS

STEP 1 · AT FIRST

how does Pepita feel?

STEP 2 · MIDDLE

what advice helps her?

STEP 3 · END

what does she say to Babette?

What does Pepita's change show about handling unkind people?

Q5

Reflection

DOK 4

Essential Question: How can people work out disagreements? Use ideas from TWO stories you read in this module.

TWO-STORY SYNTHESIS

STORY 1 · TITLE

How is the disagreement worked out in this story?

STORY 2 · TITLE

How is the disagreement worked out in this story?

MY BIG IDEA



Worksheet D — MAP Practice

Module 3 · Meet in the Middle · Grade 2

MAP RIT 180 → 200 · 4 Mini-Passages × 5 Questions

NAME _____ DATE _____

Directions. Read each short passage carefully. Then answer the 5 questions that follow. Each passage is NEW — not from the stories in this workbook.

Passage 1 · The Last Slice of Pizza

Min and her brother Tom both wanted the last slice of pizza. Min said, "I am older. I get it." Tom said, "I am hungrier. I get it." They began to argue. Their mother came in. "Stop, please," she said in a calm voice. "There is one slice and two of you. What can we do?" Min thought for a moment. "We can cut it in half," she said. "Then we both get some." Tom nodded. He cut it carefully. Each piece was the same size. Mom smiled. "That is a compromise," she said. "You each gave up a little to make it fair."

Q1

RIT 180

Lexile 250L

Key Detail

What did Min and Tom both want?

- ☐ A. A book on the shelf.
- ☐ B. A cup of milk.
- ☐ C. A toy on the table.
- ☐ D. The last slice of pizza.

Q2

RIT 184

Lexile 260L

Cause & Effect

Why did Min and Tom start to argue?

- ☐ A. They both wanted the same slice.
- ☐ B. Their mother told them to.
- ☐ C. The pizza was cold.
- ☐ D. They could not find the kitchen.

Q3

RIT 186

Lexile 270L

Vocabulary

In the passage, "calm" most likely means —

- ☐ A. loud and angry.
- ☐ B. very fast and full of fear.
- ☐ C. quiet and not upset.
- ☐ D. high and squeaky.

Q4 RIT 188 Lexile 280L Inference

Why did Mom smile at the end?

- ☐ A. Because she ate the last slice herself.
- ☐ B. Because Min won and got the whole slice.
- ☐ C. Because Tom gave up and walked away.
- ☐ D. Because the kids solved the problem by sharing fairly.

Q5 RIT 189 Lexile 290L Main Idea

What is the MAIN idea of "The Last Slice of Pizza"?

- ☐ A. Pizza is something that should never be shared.
- ☐ B. The older child should always get the last slice.
- ☐ C. An older brother will always win a fight at home.
- ☐ D. A compromise can solve a small fight in a fair way.

Passage 2 · Two Plans for the Park

The class wanted to plan a class trip. Half of the class wanted to go to the park. The other half wanted to go to the museum. They could not agree. Mrs. Lee asked them to listen to each other. "Why do you want the park?" she asked. The park group said, "We want to run and play games." "Why the museum?" she asked. The museum group said, "We want to see real bones from animals long ago." Then Mrs. Lee had an idea. "What if we go to the park in the morning and to the small museum after lunch?" Everyone smiled. They all agreed.

Q6 RIT 190 Lexile 300L Key Detail

Where did half of the class want to go?

- ☐ A. A swimming pool.
- ☐ B. A movie theater.
- ☐ C. A library in another town.
- ☐ D. The park.

Q7 RIT 192 Lexile 320L Key Detail

Why did the museum group want to go to the museum?

- ☐ A. To run and play games.
- ☐ B. To buy snacks.
- ☐ C. To see real bones from animals long ago.
- ☐ D. To take pictures of trees.

Q8 RIT 193 Lexile 330L Cause & Effect

Why did everyone smile in the end?

- ☐ A. Because Mrs. Lee gave them candy.
- ☐ B. Because the museum was closed.
- ☐ C. Because the plan let them do both things.
- ☐ D. Because school ended early.

Q9 RIT 194 Lexile 340L Inference

What kind of teacher is Mrs. Lee MOST LIKELY?

- ☐ A. A teacher who listens and helps her class solve problems.
- ☐ B. A teacher who never speaks to any of her students.
- ☐ C. A teacher who shouts at everyone until they stop.
- ☐ D. A teacher who lets just one student choose for all.

Q10 RIT 195 Lexile 350L Main Idea

What is the MAIN idea of "Two Plans for the Park"?

- ☐ A. A class trip should always be picked by just one student alone.
- ☐ B. Going to a park is always a better trip than going to a museum.
- ☐ C. Going to a museum is always a better trip than going to a park.
- ☐ D. When two groups disagree, listening can help them find a plan that works for everyone.

Passage 3 · The Bench Problem

There was one new bench in the school yard. Three friends wanted to sit on it at the same time. Eli sat down first. Then Anna came. "Move over," she said. Eli did not want to. Then Sam came. "Where do I sit?" he asked. Eli began to frown. Anna began to argue. Sam stood and waited. He did not want anyone to feel bad. He thought for a moment. Then he asked, "What if we all squeeze close together? Or what if two of us sit and one stands today, and we trade tomorrow?" The friends looked at each other. They decided to trade. Eli smiled. Anna smiled too. The bench problem was solved.

Q11 RIT 195 Lexile 360L Key Detail

How many friends wanted to sit on the bench?

- ☐ A. Two friends.
- ☐ B. Three friends.
- ☐ C. Four friends.
- ☐ D. Five friends.

Q12 RIT 196 Lexile 370L Cause & Effect

Why did Eli begin to frown?

- ☐ A. The bell rang.
- ☐ B. The bench was wet.
- ☐ C. He did not want to move over.
- ☐ D. A teacher walked by.

Q13 RIT 197 Lexile 380L Inference

Which BEST tells about Sam?

- ☐ A. He thinks of an idea so no one feels left out.
- ☐ B. He pushes Eli off the bench.
- ☐ C. He shouts at Anna.
- ☐ D. He runs straight to the teacher.

Q14 RIT 198 Lexile 390L Vocabulary

In the passage, "trade" most likely means —

- ☐ A. a kind of job or work people do.
- ☐ B. to switch — you take a turn now, I take a turn later.
- ☐ C. to give away a thing and get nothing back.
- ☐ D. to keep your spot and never let it go.

Q15 RIT 199 Lexile 400L Main Idea

What is the MAIN idea of "The Bench Problem"?

- ☐ A. A school yard is a place that is full of too many rules.
- ☐ B. Trading turns is a fair way to share something three friends all want.
- ☐ C. Only the first friend to arrive should ever get to sit down.
- ☐ D. A new bench should always be moved indoors where it is safe.

Passage 4 · Words That Build a Bridge

Long ago, two small towns sat on opposite sides of a deep river. They needed each other. One town had wheat. The other had wood. But the two towns did not get along. They had a long disagreement about an old fishing spot. One day, a baker from one town carried fresh bread across a thin path of stones. She gave a warm loaf to the children of the other town. The children laughed and ate. Their parents came out. Soon the two towns sat together and talked. They decided to share the fishing spot on different days. They built a real bridge that summer — a bridge of wood and wheat and kind words.

Q16 RIT 199 Lexile 420L Key Detail

What did the two towns have a disagreement about?

- ☐ **A.** Who owned the bridge.
- ☐ **B.** An old fishing spot.
- ☐ **C.** A load of wheat.
- ☐ **D.** A pile of wood.

Q17 RIT 200 Lexile 440L Cause & Effect

Why did the parents come out of their homes?

- ☐ **A.** The children were laughing and eating the warm bread.
- ☐ **B.** The river dried up.
- ☐ **C.** A loud horn went off.
- ☐ **D.** A storm started.

Q18 RIT 200 Lexile 460L Vocabulary

In the last line, "a bridge of wood and wheat and kind words" means a bridge built with —

- ☐ **A.** only cold metal and heavy gray stone.
- ☐ **B.** only thin paper and bits of old string.
- ☐ **C.** the things they each had and the kindness they shared.
- ☐ **D.** bricks they had to buy from another country.

Q19 RIT 200 Lexile 480L Inference

What changed the two towns FIRST?

- ☐ **A.** A war between the two towns.
- ☐ **B.** A kind act — one woman sharing bread with the children.
- ☐ **C.** A new law from a far-away king.
- ☐ **D.** A flood that washed the river away.

Q20 RIT 200 Lexile 500L Main Idea

What is the MAIN idea of "Words That Build a Bridge"?

- ☐ **A.** Kind words and small acts can begin to work out even an old disagreement.
- ☐ **B.** Fishing by the river is the best job that anyone could ever have.
- ☐ **C.** Two towns should never share the things that each one has.
- ☐ **D.** A strong bridge should only ever be built out of heavy stone.